LESSON 03 OF 06

Social Engineering

What is social engineering?

Social engineering is the manipulation of human behaviour to trick people into revealing information, granting access or performing actions that benefit an attacker.

Common psychological techniques

- **Urgency:** Making someone feel they must act immediately.
- **Fear:** Threatening account suspension or financial loss.
- **Authority:** Pretending to be a manager, executive or government official.
- **Trust:** Pretending to be a friend, colleague or known organisation.
- **Curiosity:** Using attractive offers or unexpected information.

Real-world example

Someone calls an employee pretending to be the company's technical support officer. They claim there is an urgent security issue and request the employee's login details.

> **Key lesson:** Stop, think and independently verify unusual requests, even when they appear to come from someone important.

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